



“Even negative publicity is changing EV adaptability in India. The kind of hype Ola has created has motivated a lot of customers to buy an EV. If they’re not satisfied with Ola, they’ll buy others, but demand will grow”

VINKESH GULATI
PRESIDENT,
FADA



“EVs need a lot of testing in real world conditions, which a lot of OEMs bypass. Simulations don’t work. There’s no substitute for running for lakhs of km, getting data, rectifying and refining till you launch commercially”

RAVNEET S. PHOKELA
CHIEF BUSINESS
OFFICER, ATHER ENERGY



“A few cases [of fires] after four to five years doesn’t define our quality; it’s a new technology and a learning curve for everyone... We’ll follow whatever regulation is set by the government”

JEETENDER SHARMA
FOUNDER AND MD,
OKINAWA

nologies, which operates India’s largest cab aggregator business) as its 100 per cent EV subsidiary. According to documents filed by the company with the Registrar of Companies, on December 19, 2018, Aggarwal acquired 9,250 shares at ₹10 each from ANI Technologies, giving him a holding of 92.5 per cent. Then in January 2019, Aggarwal transferred 2,185 shares to Indus Trust and OEM Employees Welfare Trust, bringing his stake down to 70.7 per cent while ANI Technologies owned 7.4 per cent.

A month later, Ola Electric raised ₹306.2 crore (\$42.2 million) in a Series A round at a valuation of ₹1,789.9 crore from Matrix Partners, Tiger Global and Sarin Family India LLC, and Aggarwal’s stake in the company fell

to 57.7 per cent. And without producing or delivering a single EV, the company became a unicorn in July 2019 after raising \$250 million from SoftBank. After a series of fund raises, Aggarwal owns 36.6 per cent stake in Ola Electric and 8.7 per cent in ANI Technologies as of April 2022.

Some analysts question how investors in the parent entity (ANI Technologies) got on board with him buying the company’s stake in a subsidiary for a small sum and then garnering huge funding. “As a company, Ola was into the taxi aggregator business. Then why are the resources being deployed in setting up the EV factory? The business for which you’re known and are raising money [for] is different from the business that you plan to do [EVs]. Till now, nobody

is clear as to when the business changed and why the shareholders of this company that is going public (Ola Cabs) is not part of that company (Ola Electric). There’s a lot of ambiguity here,” says Arun Kejriwal, Founder of Kejriwal Research and Investment Services, on the proposed Ola Cabs IPO.

But there are others who see nothing wrong in Aggarwal buying shares of a subsidiary at a low price. “It will only impact the investor, and they are informed investors. If they chose to fight it or if they were unhappy with it, they would have taken it up in the court of law. It’s their headache. It can’t happen without their knowledge. The only thing is that there’s no voice for the minority shareholders in the company. That could be a concern,” says